THE RELATIVE FAVORABILITY OF THE HOUSES

The second major classification of the *chrēmatistikos* houses is the relative benefic or malefic nature of the topics located in each house sector. The traditional texts use descriptors such as: benefic and malefic, good and bad, favorable and unfavorable, fortunate and unfortunate, or advantageous and disadvantageous. The underlying criterion is: how *favorable* are the topics of these houses in the life of an individual.

According to the Hellenistic astrologer Timæus, the seven signs that are *chrēmatistikos* are the four angular signs, (first, tenth, seventh, fourth); the two trigons to the Ascendant (fifth, ninth); and the post-ascension (*epanaphora*) of the Midheaven (eleventh). The rest of the signs are *achrēmatistikos* (second, third, sixth, eighth, twelfth).[25]

This passage only makes sense within the context of the whole-sign house system, in which signs and houses coincide. It is the configurations of the signs themselves that provide the basis for this classification. What distinguishes this classification of favorable houses is that they are all configured by whole-sign aspects to the Ascendant sign. Furthermore, the signs have an intrinsic relationship with one another based upon gender, quadruplicity, and triplicity (as discussed in volume one). The Ascendant symbolizes the life of the individual and as such serves as the reference point for the topics of life that are favorable and unfavorable for the life force and its trajectory. Because aspects are connected to rays of light and vision, the houses that receive the light of life from the Ascendant are highly visible and thus function as prime locations for the business of life.

Using the first house of life as the point of reference, the sides of the hexagon connect the first house to the third and eleventh houses by sextile. The sides of the square connect the first house to the fourth and tenth houses. The sides of

the peak is clearly in the cadent twelfth house. The second peak falls in the ninth house, another cadent house. I have been thinking about how to reconcile this finding with the traditional doctrine of angularity for several years. One line of speculation is that if a planet is ten to twenty degrees above the Ascendant, it would have been rising over the Ascendant two hours prior. This is the approximate interval when transition in childbirth begins; the mother's labor intensifies as the fetus leaves the uterus to travel down the birth canal. Could it be the case that if a planet is crossing the Ascendant when transition begins, that planet has a marked imprint in the life of the native? This preserves the power of angularity linked to the Ascendant degree. In a similar fashion, a second peak in the cadent ninth house correlates to about eight hours prior to birth, which is the average time of labor as a whole. Likewise, a planet crossing the Ascendant at the onset of labor will be located near the ninth house at the time of birth, and may leave a strong impression in the adult's professional life.

25 ANTIOCHUS, *Summary* 19; PORPHYRY, *Introduction* 36; RHETORIUS, *Compendium* 27–28.

BCE), who elevated the Master and Lord of the Nativity above all other planets in terms of their importance in the life as a whole.[1]

The Predominator (*Epikratētōr*) under ideal circumstances is the ruling light, either the Sun or the Moon. The Predominator is the source of the vital force that resides in the individual and signifies the animating power of life in the chart. In certain cases, the Predominator can be the Ascendant or even the Lot of Fortune, the Prenatal Lunation, or any planet. The Predominator appoints the Master. It is also used on its own for timing longevity by primary directions, and in this capacity it is called the "releaser" (or in some texts, the "prorogator"), from the Greek *aphetēs*.

The Master of the Nativity (*Oikodespotēs*) hosts the vital life force and distributes the years of the life. It is derived from the Predominator as one of its lords. It was used primarily in timing longevity by means of planetary periods, and sometimes in the analysis of constitution and character.

The Lord of the Nativity (*Kurios*) is the most dignified planet in the chart according to multiple criteria. There are hints that it guides the soul and executes the plan and purpose of the life. The *Kurios* is a shadowy figure mentioned by only a few astrologers; later texts conflate the procedures for determining the *Kurios* with those for the *Oikodespotēs*.

Table 84. Terms for Predominator, Master, and Lord of the Nativity

ENGLISH	GREEK	PERSIAN/ARABIC	LATIN
PREDOMINATOR (RELEASER, PROROGATOR)	*Epikratētōr (aphetēs)*	*Hīlāj*	*Hyleg*
MASTER OF THE NATIVITY	*Oikodespotēs*	*Al-kadkhudāh*	*Alcochoden*
LORD OF THE NATIVITY	*Kurios*	*Al-mubtazz*	*Almuten*

The procedures for determining the Predominator, Master, and Lord of the Nativity continued to be discussed and elaborated upon during the Arabic and Medieval periods. The table above gives the corresponding terminology in the

1 ANTIOCHUS, *Summary* 1.29, 2.3; PORPHYRY, *Commentary* 30.

OPTION 2: IS THE CHART A NIGHT CHART?

1. *If* YES, *look to the Moon.*
2. *Is the Moon in the second, first, eleventh, or tenth house?*
3. *If* YES, *the Moon is the Predominator because of sect, relative angularity, and easterly directional rising.*
4. *Is the Moon in the twelfth or ninth house?*
5. *If* YES, *the Moon is disqualified because it is cadent. It is also disqualified if it is located in one of the other cadent houses, the third or the sixth.*
6. *Look to the Sun. Is the Sun in the second house or below the horizon in the first house?*
7. *If* YES, *the Sun is the Predominator because of relative angularity and easterly directional rising.*

OPTION 3: IS THE CHART A NIGHT CHART WITH BOTH THE SUN AND MOON BENEATH THE HORIZON?

(When you investigate the first or seventh houses, be sure you are looking at the interval *beneath* the degree of the Ascendant/Descendant axis).

1. *Are both the Sun and Moon located in angular houses (first, fourth, or seventh) or succedent houses (second or fifth)?*
2. *If* YES, *predomination will go to the Moon because she is the light of the sect.*
3. *Is the Moon located in the third or sixth house while the Sun is in the second, fourth, or under the horizon in the first or seventh?*
4. *If* YES, *the Sun is the Predominator because of relative angularity.*
5. *Are both the Sun and Moon located in the third or sixth houses?*
6. *If* YES, *predomination goes to the Ascendant.*
7. *There are no instructions for predomination if the Sun is in the fifth house and the Moon is in the third or sixth.*
8. *Does your chart have a predominating light?*
9. *If* YES, *is it the Sun or the Moon?*
10. *If* NO, *predomination defaults to the Ascendant.*

REMEMBER: the whole point of the Predominator is to indicate the place of the most potent life force in your chart. Having ascertained this, you can then use the Predominator to determine the Master of the Nativity.

THE ASCENSIONAL TIMES OF THE SIGNS

The ascensional times of the signs are the varying amounts of time that it takes for a sign to fully ascend over the horizon. While the average rate of ascension is two hours per sign (twenty-four hours divided by twelve signs), due to the obliquity of the ecliptic, some signs take longer to rise than other signs. This is the origin of the distinction between signs of short and long ascension. The latitude of the place also affects the actual time elapsed. The ascensional times of each sign are derived from the number of degrees that pass over the degree of the Midheaven as each zodiacal sign rises over the eastern horizon. The number of these degrees is converted into the years of life. Yet, because the ascensional time of each sign differs, each degree in that sign can correspond to a period that is greater or lesser than one year of life.

At locations on or near the equator, the signs have similar rates of ascension. In these places, one degree is approximately equivalent to one year. However, as the latitude increases, the different ascension rates of the signs diverge. At extreme latitudes, one degree can equate to almost two years of life in some signs, and in others to only several weeks. In the table below (Table 96) the northern latitudes are reversed for southern latitudes; whereas in the Northern Hemisphere, Aries and Pisces are signs of short ascension and Virgo and Libra are signs of long ascension, in the Southern Hemisphere, Aries and Pisces are long and Virgo and Libra are short. At latitudes greater than 23.5° north, the signs Leo and Scorpio have the longest ascensional times and at latitudes greater than 23.5° south, the signs Taurus and Aquarius have the longest ascensional times. Note that these latitudes mark the Sun's greatest declinations north and south of the equator at the Tropics of Cancer and Capricorn respectively.[5]

Table 96. Signs of Long and Short Ascension

Northern hemisphere		*Southern hemisphere*	
♈-♓	Shortest	♉-♍	Longest
♉-♍	Shorter	♈-♓	Longer
♊-♑	Short	♊-♑	Long
♋-♐	Long	♋-♐	Short
♏-♎	Longer	♌-♏	Shorter
♌-♏	Longest	♏-♎	Shortest

5 Data derived from astro-seek.com, calculated for January 01, 2000 with the kind assistance of Petr Soural, based on Rob Hand's method ('On the Invariance of the Tropical Zodiac').